

or isn't supported, it will move on to the next audio source. In addition, we can embed a Flash player if all else fails:

- `<audio controls preload="auto" autobuffer>`
- `<source src="elvis.mp3" />`
- `<source src="elvis.ogg" />`
- `<!-- now include flash fall back -->`
- `</audio>`

Cross-Browser Implementation

The earlier audio players relied on Flash to implement the player's graphical interface, effectively isolating the player from the rest of the web design process. With growing support for HTML5 in modern browsers, developers are breaking their Flash dependency and now using native audio as it is supported.

One of the most significant issue is the cross-browser implementation, where lack of a common supported audio format among browsers causes complications. If developers want to take full advantage of all browsers that support HTML5 audio, they'll need to create both MP3 and Ogg (and in Opera's case, WAV) versions of the audio file they want to stream!

Since the HTML5 standard is still a work in progress, several aspects of the `<audio>` element vary from browser to browser. For example, there seems to be no way to determine the load progress of an audio file in all browsers as this relies on buffered DOM attribute being implemented. Chrome has implemented buffered while in Safari it's there but it behaves slightly differently. In order to compete effectively with plugin-based solutions, it is necessary that HTML5 audio implementation be consistent across all browsers and match current implementations feature for feature.

JavaScript solutions

In order to take advantage of each browser's audio capabilities, it is necessary to create different solutions for different browsers. You will need to check what capabilities a particular browser supports and adapt accordingly. Using JavaScript, you can check for audio tag support and file compatibility:

- `// returns a boolean`
- `var audioTagSupport= !! (document.createElement('audio').canPlayType);`
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- `// Need to check the canPlayType first or an exception`
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